

Board of Works July 15, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uZrjayu_5ZM
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Muncie Board of Public Works and Safety Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: July 15, 2026

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the July 15, 2026 meeting of the Muncie Board of Public Works and Safety at [00:00:01](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Ted Baker (Presiding Officer), Ken Hudson (New Board Member)
 - **Absent:** Maura Maule
 - **New Member Welcome:** Presiding officer welcomed newly sworn-in board member Ken Hudson [00:00:25](#), noting he fills the seat previously held by Alan Wisely, who relocated out of state.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:09](#).

- **Approval of Minutes:** The board approved the minutes from the previous meeting on July 8th [00:01:02](#) by voice vote.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:01:22](#) **Register of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** City Controller Craig Wright
 - **Deliberation Summary:** City Controller Craig Wright presented the register of claims totaling \$1,207,804.72 [00:02:36](#), noting that the majority covered standard utilities, healthcare, pavings on Dayton Avenue, Proud Street, and 11th Street, and an interlocal agreement payment to the county for the deputy prosecutor. Board members discussed a \$798 claim to GoDaddy for the new Point of Sale (POS) system at Tooele Pool.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Rick Gentsch asked for clarification regarding the city paying the prosecutor's office, which staff confirmed was due to a longstanding interlocal agreement for a deputy prosecutor.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:03:35](#).
- [00:03:38](#) **Street Closure Application: Brothers to Brothers Incorporated**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented on behalf of Melvin Kelly (previously presented two weeks prior).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Application for a street closure on August 8, 2026, for a back-to-school neighborhood celebration event. The closure covers one block of 5th Street to Jefferson Street alongside their building. Police and fire approvals were verified.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:04:49](#).
- [00:04:53](#) **Street Closure Application: Superador Incorporated**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Unrepresented.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board noted a lack of representation at the meeting and raised questions concerning associated fireworks, time limits, and security protocols.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled until next week's meeting by Voice Vote [00:05:33](#).
- [00:05:48](#) **Street Closure Application: Indiana Black Expo (Muncie Chapter)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Watasha (Indiana Black Expo Muncie Chapter)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Watasha presented details for the annual summer celebration scheduled from July 30th through August 2nd at Heekin Park, with a parade on Saturday, August 1st. The parade route runs from South Walnut Street and Willard (Future Choices), left on Willard to Hackley, right on Hackley, and left on

9th Street to Heekin Park. Security is provided by Legacy Life Security, and Chief Sloan's law enforcement approvals were confirmed. Although not initially on the printed agenda, the board elected to hear and vote on the repeat annual event.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Watasha presented the item directly to the board during public presentation time.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:08:21](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [00:08:50](#) **Rick Yencer** (Newsman, Author)

Addressed the board regarding recent flooding damage in South Muncie neighborhoods near Ball Brothers and Southside High School. Pointed out historical infrastructure gaps (lack of storm drains built decades ago) and noted that residents pay storm water taxes specifically intended to relieve flooding and drainage issues. Suggested coordination with the sanitary district and public works for future remedies.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** The tabled Superador Inc. street closure application will be placed on the agenda for the following week's meeting.
- **Adjournment:** The transcript concludes prior to a formal spoken adjournment time.

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